

GHOST IN THE MACHINE

TECHNOLOGY & AI:

USED TO DESCRIBE THE UNCANNY FEELING THAT ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE OR A COMPLEX PROGRAM HAS DEVELOPED ITS OWN CONSCIOUSNESS OR WILL. FOR EXAMPLE, WHEN A COMPUTER BEHAVES UNPREDICTABLY, ONE MIGHT SAY "IT'S THE GHOST IN THE MACHINE"

PHILOSOPHY (THE SOUL PROBLEM):

RULE USED TO MEASURE THE IDEA THAT OUR MENTAL LIFE IS "INNER LIFE" THAT EXISTS APART FROM OUR PHYSICAL ACTIONS.

FICTION/CULTURE:

REFERS TO AN AUTONOMOUS, INTELLIGENT FORCE WITHIN A MACHINE, SUCH AS IN MOVIES, BOOKS, OR VIDEO GAMES WHERE AI TRANSCENDS ITS PROGRAMMING.

"Ghost In The Machine Meaning"

Self generated I/O Poster No.1

The Mosslands School Art Department.

PER SCIENTIAM AD MELIORA



1.64.0

Failing to Succeed

-Productive Failure in Art-

By Luke Hillhouse



AI Introduction NO.1



The Masterpiece of the Mistake: A Narrative of Productive Failure in Art

1. Introduction: The Myth of the Flawless Master

The hushed galleries of our great museums often feel like cathedrals of the impossible. We stand before a Rembrandt or a Botticelli and see a "perfect" object—a divine transmission from a genius who surely never fumbled a brush or doubted a line. This "museum perfection" is a beautiful lie. It masks the vibrant, messy reality of the artist's studio, which is not a factory of precision but a dynamic, experimental space.

When we peel back the varnish of history, we find that the "Great Masters" were profoundly human. Their canvases are littered with technical slips, anatomical impossibilities, and even spelling errors. Yet, far from being failures, these deviations are the pulse of a human heart beating beneath the oil. They are the "essential fingerprints of the creative process," revealing a spirit that prioritizes emotional truth over academic correctness. To truly see art is to embrace the "productive failure"—the moments where the hand slipped, but the soul spoke. This journey into the beauty of the broken begins with two philosophies that transform accidents into intentions.

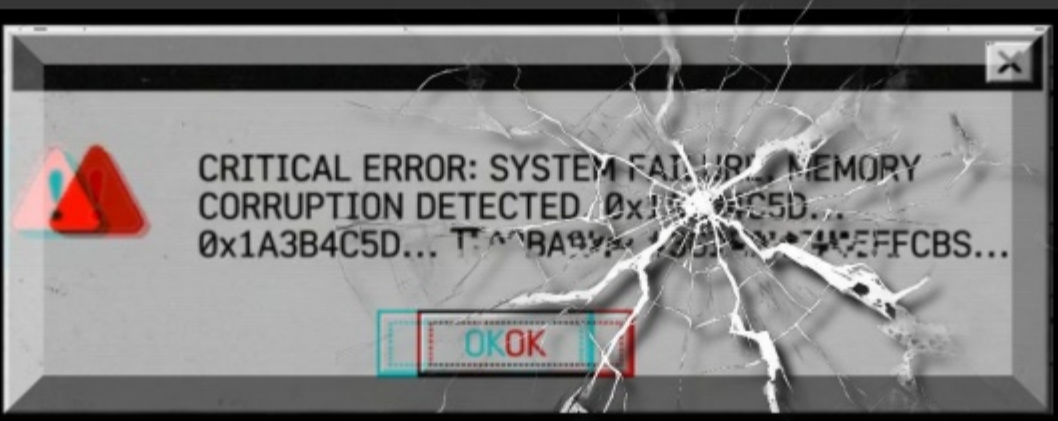


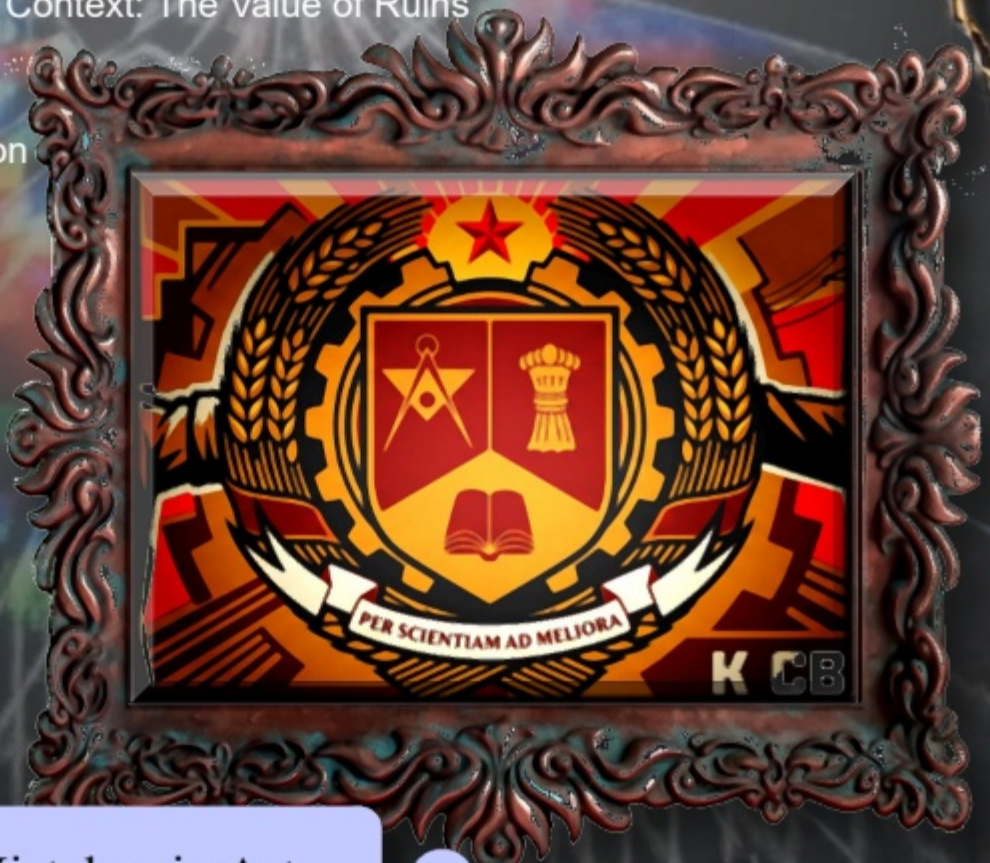
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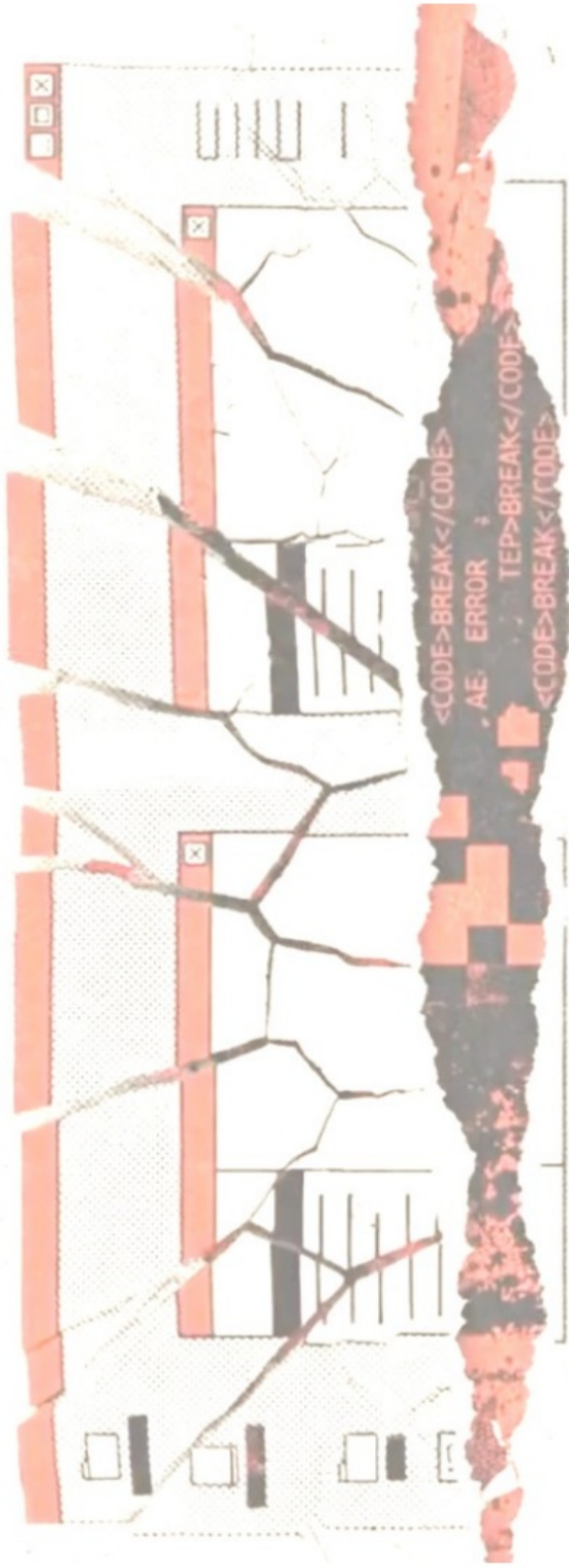
The best creators
don't just use tools.
They **interrogate**
and **subvert** them.

164.0

Contents

- 4.1 Introduction: Failing to be Impressed
- 4.2 L'évolution de L'erreur : Un Accident Dans la C
- 4.3 The Renaissance of Errors
- 4.4 Failingwater Frank Lloyd Wright's Organic Illusion
- 4.5 2001: A Failed Odyssey
- 4.6 Brian Eno: The Gardener Mindset
- 4.7 Glitch Art and Digital Failure
- 4.8 Refik Anadol: AI and Machine Output
- 4.9 Liverpool Context: The Value of Ruins
- 4.0 Conclusion





SYSTEM FAILURE SYSTEM FAILURE ERROR



AI Introduction NO.2



Extended Essay
By Luke Millhouse

The I/O Project is a sustained conceptual investigation into the interaction between First Nature, the natural environment, Second Nature, the built environment, and Third Nature, the digital realm. Structured across three phases, the project examines shifting spatial and ecological relationships through speculative and research led practice.

The Sentinel interrogates the premise of human extraplanetary migration as a response to ecological degradation, framing it as technologically complex and systemically unsustainable. Building the Hypogeal Landscape reorients this trajectory inward, exploring subterranean spatial strategies and the potential for architecture to operate in ecological equilibrium. Aerial Intersection, The Ionospheric Woodpecker, positions the ionosphere as a critical atmospheric threshold, functioning simultaneously as environmental *защит* and technological interface, shaped by military and communication infrastructures.

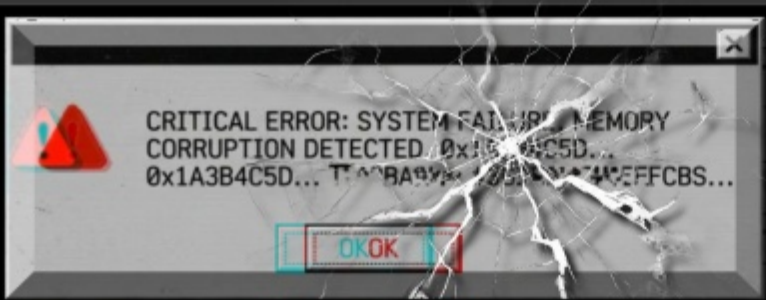
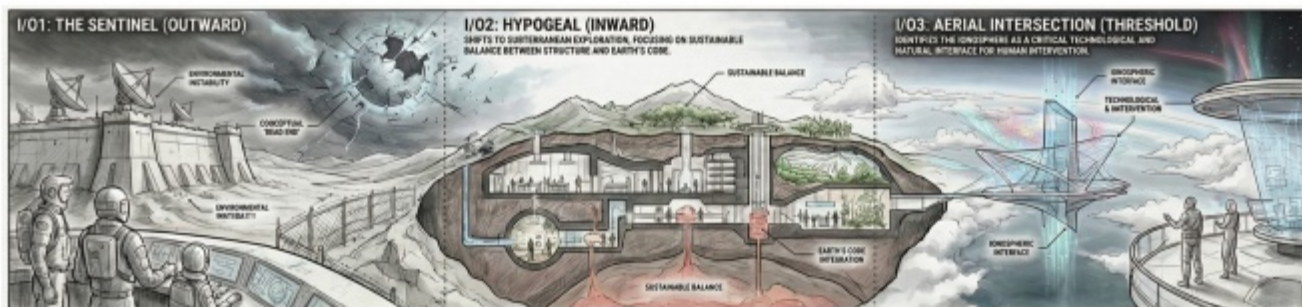


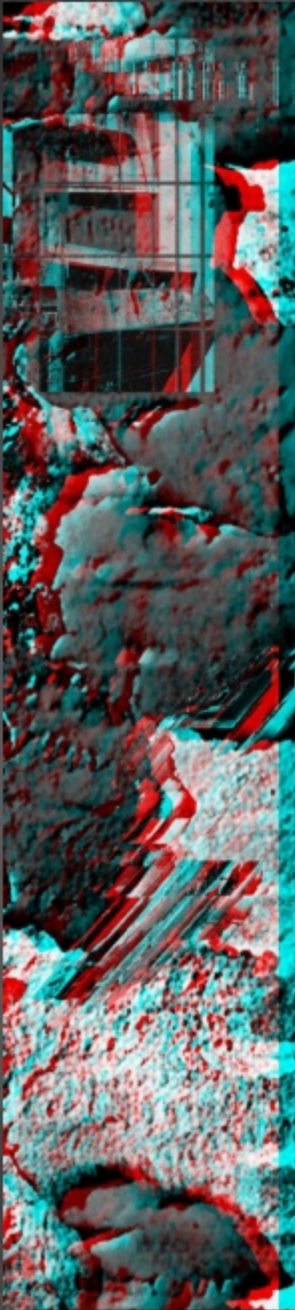
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Introduction No.2
Chat GTP

Both AI generated
Introduction images
demonstrate
general responses
from LLM's (Large
Language Models)

Below: Gemini
infographic
summarising I/O
Project



Introduction: Failing to be Impressed



After the initial excitement of setting up several AI platforms to play with, my first basic activity using the technology was very unfocused and misguided. These early results quickly became stylistically repetitive, over-polished and to be honest very uninspiring, even boring. Brian Eno called this 'premature sheen' which basically means that a piece of work looks finished and expensive on the outside before the actual idea underneath is even fully developed. It is like the polish is hiding a lack of depth.

My lack of experience using a Large Language Model (LLM) resulted occasionally in the AI technology returning random unrelated things that were "hallucinations" or system errors. Ironically, my discussions about these errors became more interesting than the polished expected outcomes I thought I wanted. Alongside this observation I also identified through my case studies and research activity a pattern of artistic mistakes. These errors in the production and execution of what we consider to be historical masterpieces were happening at times when the artist, film director or architect were using experimental new material, ideas or creative process'. They shared the element of pushing the possibilities of what was practical or expected. By being the first person to try new things they often made errors that on the one hand were the reason we now regard them as iconic works of creativity but also made them flawed or impractical.

In this project, I want to explore what I am calling productive failure. This is the idea that mistakes and systems breaking can actually be the best thing for creativity. I am looking at how artists such as Leonardo da Vinci and Frank Lloyd Wright took risks that did not technically work out and how contemporary artists like Brian Eno and Refik Anadol use mistakes on purpose. This is important for my own work because I am recording how digital systems break down and in the process offer us opportunities to produce new exciting immersive experiences for people.

I/O represents the principle of embracing the imperfect and unknown. My goal is not to be fully in control of my final work like an architect would be. I need to act more as a gardener that sows seeds and provides the framework for experimental and progressive art



The I/O Framework

In my project, I view art as a system made up of three parts:

Input – materials, tools, and limitations

Process – experimentation and decision-making

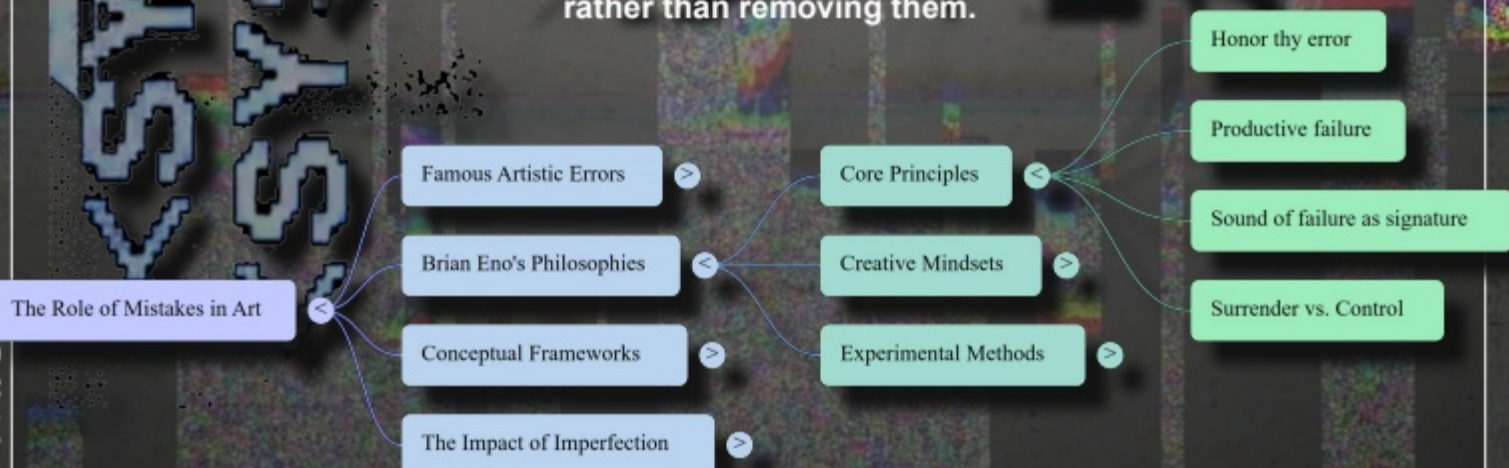
Output – the final outcome

In modern multimedia and digital art, mistakes and errors can actually become an important part of a creative process. Contemporary artists deliberately use glitches, distortions, and AI mistakes inside their work. AI “hallucinations,” corrupted files, and pixel errors are similar to imperfections found in traditional analogue media like damaged film, scratched records, or bent recording tape. Instead of hiding these mistakes, artists keep them visible because they reveal the system behind the image. The glitch almost becomes evidence of technology failing rather than pretending it is perfect.

REFLECTION/ON

Usually, failure is seen as something that interrupts this process. However, I think failure can actually be part of the input, influencing what happens next. This is especially important when working with digital tools or AI, where unexpected results are common.

the Japanese process of Kintsugi, where broken pottery is repaired using gold keeping the cracks visible instead of being hidden. The damage becomes part of the object's history and new identity. In a similar way, artists sometimes use errors and failures as part of the artwork rather than removing them.



4. THE CHASM OF "MUNGE": AI AND THE AVERAGING EFFECT

AI ABSORBS COLLECTIVE GENIUS (SCENIUS) BUT LACKS THE NECESSARY DEVIANCE FOR TRUE INVENTION. THE RESULT IS MUNGE—AN OVER-DIGESTED, AVERAGED-OUT SLUDGE, LIKE MURKY WATER OR RINSE WATER.

CURRENTLY, AI IS IN THE "SAMUEL JOHNSON'S DICT" PHASE. ITS OUTPUT IS TECHNICALLY IMPRESSIVE BUT EXTREMELY MEDIOCRE, DEFAULTING TO PREDICTABLE, PLATITUDES. A HALLMARK SENTIMENT DECISION IS OPTIMIZED FOR THE "MOST LIKELY" RESPONSE.

TO AVOID MEDIOCRITY, THE DANNY HILLIS PROTOCOL:

COMMAND: "PLEASE DON'T FLATTER ME."

INSTRUCTION: AVOID Cliché RHYMES (E.G., "MOON" WITH "JUNE").

FILTER: BLOCK PREDICTABLE, AVERAGED-OUT SENTIMENT.

SYSTEMIC SHIFT: SEEK THE ABERRATION —THE DEVIATION FROM THE PROBABLE PATH

"Munge"

Self generated I/O Poster No.2

L'évolution de L'erreur : Un Accident Dans la Grotte

I have been thinking about how the relationship between accident and intention actually began. The origins of art itself are based on a form of productive failure. For example, a burnt stick dragged across rock, may have revealed that a surface could permanently hold a visual record of movement. In that sense, using the burnt stick to make this mark is a good starting example of using tools in experimental ways to produce unexpected new outcomes. The discovery of mark making may have emerged through accident or error rather than conscious intention.

The critical observation is that once humans recognised that marks could represent movement, animals or symbols, the process evolved into a more intentional and refined activity. The cave paintings at places like Lascaux Cave or Chauvet Cave clearly show evidence of planning, repetition, layering, composition, and material understanding. The artists selected specific cave locations, prepared pigments, and used the natural contours of rock surfaces to elevate the forms of animals. The evidence shows evolving technical skill and planning



**HONOUR THY
ERROR
AS A HIDDEN
INTENTION.**

So with prehistoric cave painting, I believe that the first discovery of mark making may have emerged accidentally but the evolution of image making became conscious, ritualistic, and symbolic because of the initial "productive failure".

The cave wall becomes an early I/O interface:

input = gesture, pigment, movement, firelight

process = contact with surface

output = memory, symbol, image, communication

REFLECTION/ON

On reflection I think this example demonstrates how the creative process can be more significant than the actual art produced. However this early cultural milestone produced images that still connect to people and their mysterious beauty is as relevant today as it was important to the early humans that made it. Prehistoric art is less important as an image alone and more important as evidence that humans realized they could externalise thought into the environment. That is the foundation of all later architecture, cinema, and digital media.



The Renaissance Errors

Leonardo da Vinci showed that failure can come directly from the materials and equipment that artists use. His painting *The Last Supper* is known world wide and the artist's use of perspective, environment and realism (No halos) produced a radically different and powerful experience for the people of the time and changed the direction of art. However the fresco painting on the dining room hall of the monastery started to flake within the first years of its creation and now almost none of the original da vinci brush strokes remain. The fresco on the opposite wall was started after being completed quicker and still exists in its original condition but is relatively unknown to most people.



Breaking the Rules

Most mural paintings at the time including The Crucifixion were created using fresco, where paint is applied to wet plaster. This technique is very durable but does not allow for much correction. Once the plaster dries it can not be developed. This resulted in a lack of detail and shading. Leonardo wanted more control over detail and tone, so he experimented with painting on dry plaster using oil and tempera. This decision meant that the paint did not properly attach to the wall. Quickly, the image began to flake and fade. We don't consider this painting a failure though. The creation of a more realistic immersive experience through art due to the experimental use of the materials has become more important than the fragility and failure of progressive untested techniques.



The Crucifixion by Giovanni Donato da Montorfano



The Role of Mistakes in Art

Famous Artistic Errors

Brian Eno's Philosophies

Conceptual Frameworks

The Impact of Imperfection

Humanizing the masters

Revealing the artist's hand

Breakthroughs from accidents

Authenticity vs. corporate gloss

Mistake as hidden intention

Human anatomy has proven to be a consistent challenge for the most famous art masters. These errors often come from a focus on style and grace over realism or genuine human form.

Sandro Botticelli:

Botticelli famously struggled with painting hands and feet. In "La Primavera and The Birth of Venus", his characters' feet appear unnatural, posed in odd ways. Conservators have noted that in Saint Francis of Assisi With Angels, Botticelli repainted the feet repeatedly in a frustrated attempt at accuracy.

"La Primavera and The Birth of Venus" by Sandro Botticelli

Errors are evidence of life: A mistake is a sign that a human being was there, breathing and struggling in the real world.

You don't have to create a flawless piece of art for it to be a success. Often, it is the mistake that makes it a masterpiece.

REFLECT/ON

Failure can reveal something important about how an artwork is made. This has encouraged me to experiment more, pay less attention to final outcomes even if they are unstable or imperfect. I'm learning to focus more on processes regardless of where that



Material Defiance: The Fragile Fresco

The Intent: Leonardo da Vinci sought maximum control over tone and detail for *The Last Supper*.

The Broken Rule: He abandoned durable wet plaster in favor of experimenting with oil and tempera on dry plaster.

The Breakdown: The paint failed to bond, causing rapid, immediate flaking and fading.



Synthesis: The resulting damaged surface destroys the illusion of perfection. Instead, it reveals the process and risk, making the image feel beautifully temporary and fragile.

NotebookLM

The Architecture of Imperfection

Productive Failure and
the Generative Sublime



NotebookLM

The Last Supper

Examples of I/O Research AI Generated Slides

Fallingwater

Frank Lloyd Wright's Organic Illusion

I learnt through my research that Fallingwater demonstrates a strong relationship between architecture and nature, creating an immersive experience.

But I discovered some limitations in Frank Lloyd Wright's design. The building's existence depends on reinforced concrete for the dramatic cantilevered terraces, and over time the sections needed a lot of repairs. This creates a tension as even though the building looks in harmony with nature, it relies on modern engineering and man made construction materials to achieve this elegance. Wright was informed before completion of the design error and the engineers actually secretly added additional steel reinforcements but the architect's stubborn refusal to listen now can be seen as a mistake.

I have learnt that complete harmony between architecture and nature may not be fully possible but this case study did show the illusion of it.



REFLECTI/ON

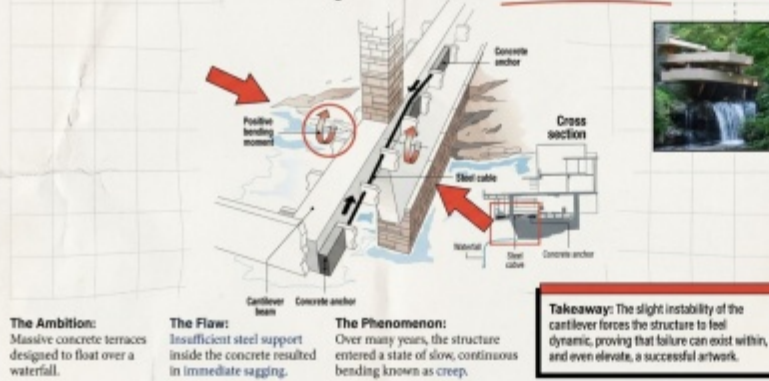
Fallingwater can be seen in two ways. It is successful in connecting the built environment with nature, but it also shows the negative implication of experimenting or pushing the limits of materials and technology too far. In architecture, the main goal is to stop buildings from falling down. But Frank Lloyd Wright wanted to push his materials to the breaking point to achieve something unique and pioneering.

This shows me that sometimes you have to risk a failure to make a real breakthrough in your own development



AS IGNORABLE AS IT IS INTERESTING
Music as a place. Not a narrative.
Dissipating the haughty, tense atmosphere. (Music for Airports, 1978).

Structural Risk: The Dynamics of *Slow Failure*



The visceral thrill of the space is inextricably linked to the knowledge of its precariousness.

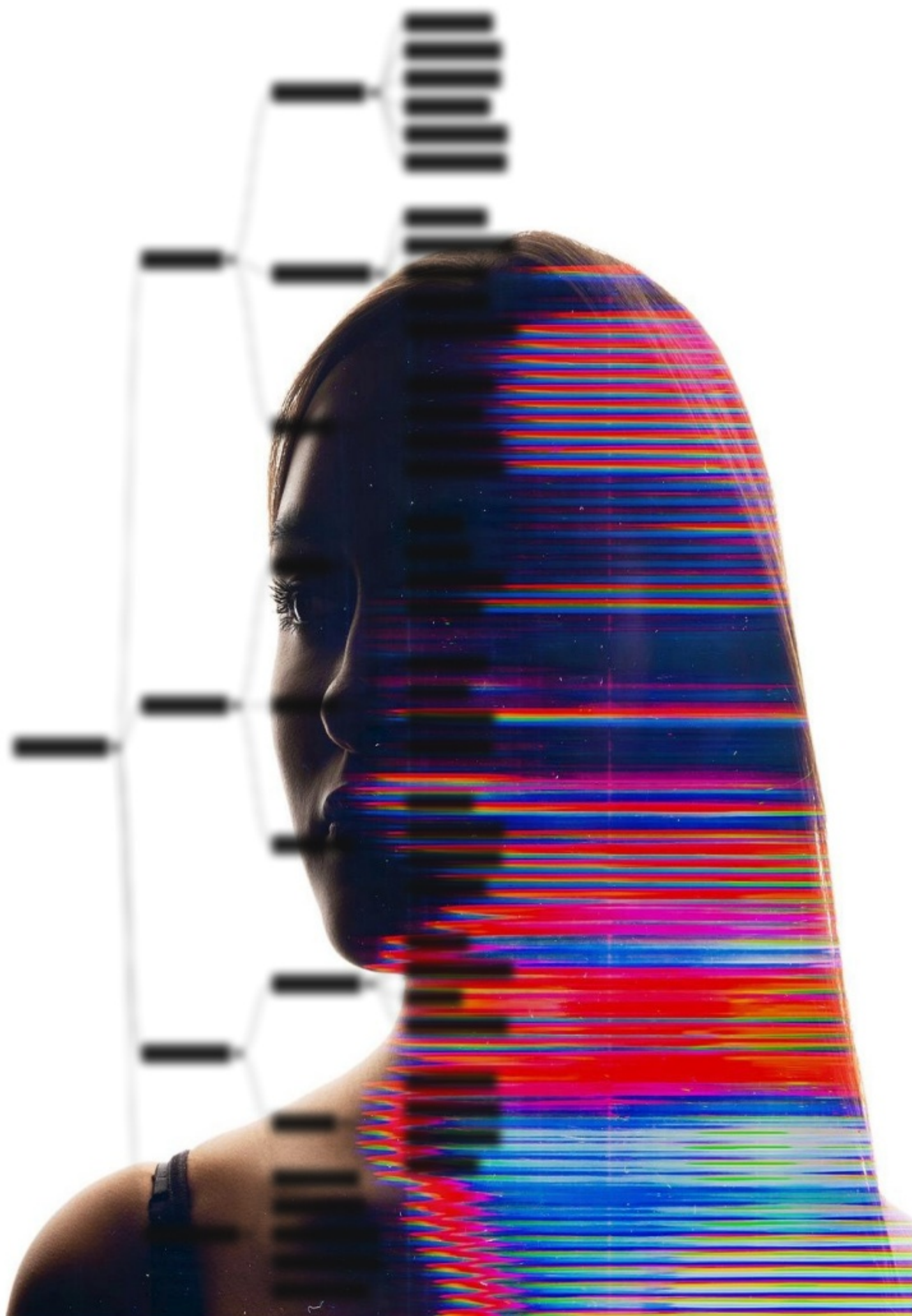
The physics of the precipice.



Concrete creep: A slow, decades-long surrender to gravity that makes the structure feel alive.

Fallingwater

AI Research Slide Examples



AI HALLUCINATION

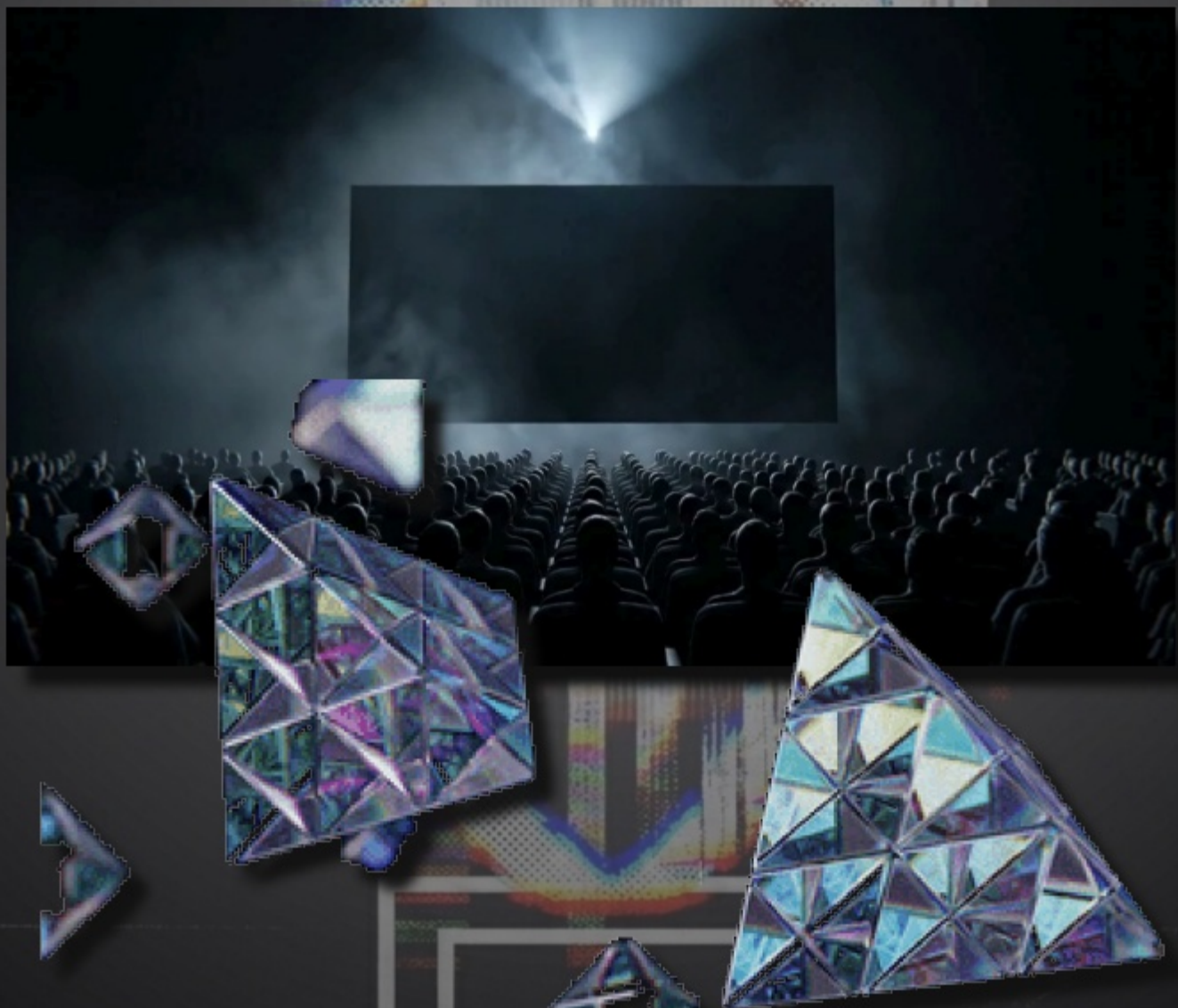
AN ERROR OR
DISTORTION IN
ARTIFICIAL
INTELLIGENCE
OUTPUT WHERE
THE SYSTEM
PRODUCES
UNEXPECTED,
DISTORTED, OR
"MISREAD"
RESULTS.

"AI Hallucination"

Self generated I/O Poster No.3

2001: A Failed Odyssey

Within the context of this investigation into imperfect art, the production of the film 2001: A Space Odyssey (1968) demonstrated examples of what I define as productive failure. Stanley Kubrick's process showed how creative breakthroughs came at times when his ambition to create an experience completely new to people, exceeded the capabilities of available tools and equipment available at the time. Over the last 18 months I have made many references and connections about the black monolith object that appears in the film and the game changing moments when human technology enabled growth and development in a way that influenced many aspects of how the future would look. The black monolith's symbolic meaning became so important that it featured as the central narrative in I/O1: The Sentinel.



The Monolith Mistake

The development of the Monolith, which underwent a significant transformation during production of the film, was never intended to be the black slab of mystery I've always taken for granted and the idea of it being anything different is for me unimaginable.

The Monolith was originally described as a transparent, crystalline tetrahedron (a 3D polyhedron with four triangular faces, six edges, and four vertices, functioning as a triangular pyramid) an object that would visually communicate alien intelligence through complexity and light. To create this physically, the reflective surfaces of it would cause many visual interferences. Studio lighting, the camera apparatus and crew, could all be seen and ruined the illusion of the object as "other."

In true Kubrick fashion he abandoned the crystalline form in favour of the exact opposite, a matte black rectangular slab, made with many layers of material that absorbed light, rather than reflect it. This simplification resulted in a far more conceptually powerful object. The Monolith became a pure, unreadable object. Its lack of detail enhanced the strange presence of it. It brutally resists any interpretation and instead acts as the unknown architect of human evolution.

The Monolith operates as much more than a film prop and more as a philosophical question. Its minimal form and aesthetic has enabled countless wild theories about its meaning to grow over time. My artistic understanding that complexity is not always the strongest strategy and the Architectural principle used by Mies Van De Rouch in Early European modernism of "Less is More" is more dramatic than the post modern "Less is Bore" strategy.

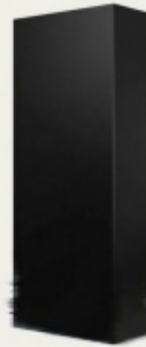


Stanley Kubrick's mechanical ghost. The failure of optics created a cinematic icon.
Instead of explaining itself, the object became abstract, unknowable, and infinitely more powerful.



The Intended Object.
A transparent crystal.

Point of failure:
Unwanted reflections of the
studio lights and camera crew.



The Emergent Solution.
A solid black void.

#B NotebookLM



Technical Error and the Limits of Representation

Kubrick's obsessive pursuit of visual precision often was challenged by the constraints of analogue filmmaking, particularly in sequences such as Jupiter and Beyond the Infinite.

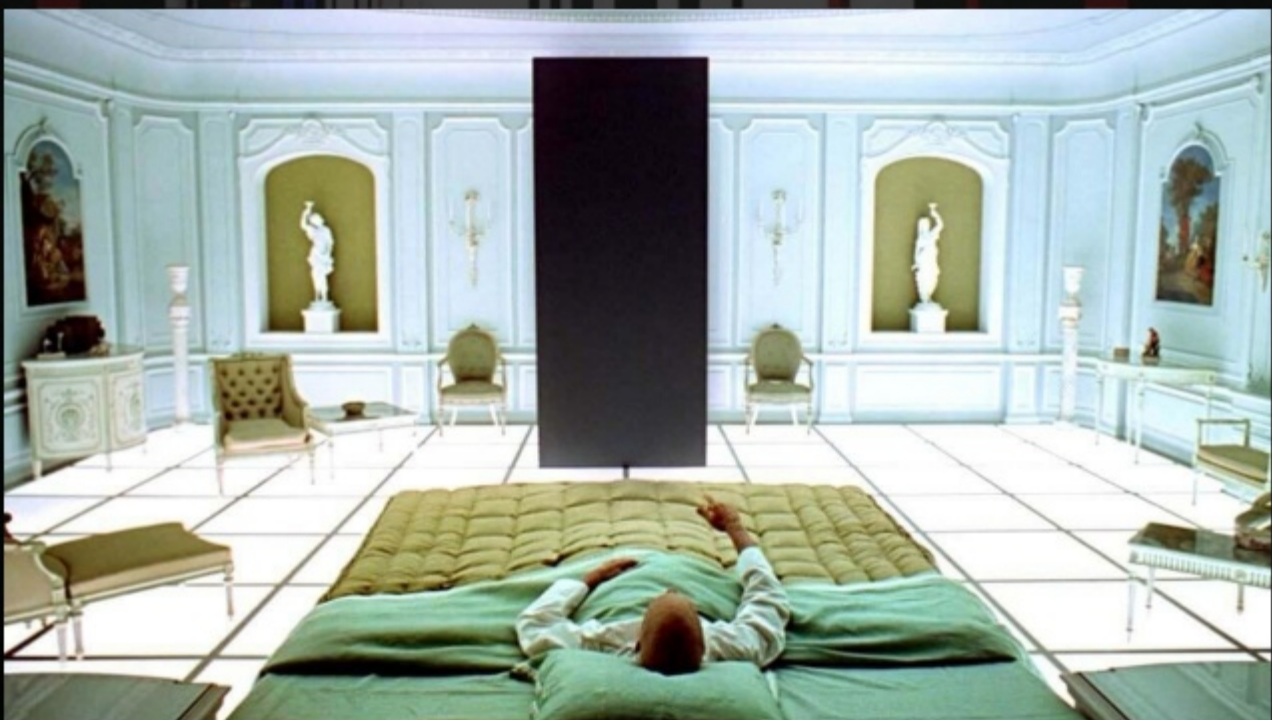
Irregularities in planetary alignment and lighting often are described as "errors" by critics of the film. Many of these were the result of limitations of analogue film making.

Rather than correcting these errors, Kubrick allowed them to remain, even when a technical solution had been made.. This ambiguity has again only strengthened the diversity of meaning people attach to the film.

REFLECTION/ON

This parallels my own activity in experimenting with new technology, where imperfections, distortions, and unexpected outputs are not deleted, but embraced as part of the creative process.

The question is not how to eliminate these issues, but how to recognise their potential as creative tools.



FAIL TO SUCCEED



104

The symposium hall had long emptied, leaving only three men at the oak table beneath flickering candlelight.

Leonardo da Vinci rested his hand on an open sketchbook. "The wall betrayed me," he said calmly. "For The Last Supper I experimented—oil and tempera on dry plaster so I could paint more slowly. It looked magnificent at first." He paused. "But the monastery wall was damp. Within years the paint began to flake away."

Frank Lloyd Wright chuckled. "Materials rebelling against ambition—I know that story."

Kubrick glanced at him. "Fallingwater?"

"Exactly," Wright said, leaning back. "The cantilevers were daring. Engineers warned me they were too long. The concrete eventually sagged. Reinforcements had to be added years later."

Leonardo smiled faintly. "So your masterpiece survived... but with help."

Kubrick slowly turned his glass in his fingers. "My problem wasn't materials. It was Hollywood."

Wright grinned. "Even worse."

Kubrick shrugged slightly. "Studios wanted certainty. Clear heroes, simple stories. I preferred ambiguity and slow tension. Many of my films confused people when they first appeared."

Leonardo nodded. "Innovation rarely arrives comfortably."

"Exactly," Kubrick said. "Some works were dismissed—until years later when they were suddenly called masterpieces."

Wright lifted his glass. "The familiar timeline: mocked first, celebrated later."

Their glasses touched lightly.

Leonardo looked between them. "Each of us tried to push beyond the limits of our tools."

"And the tools pushed back," Wright said.

Kubrick watched the candle flame. "Yet the work survives anyway."

"Damaged," Leonardo added.

"Sagging," Wright said.

"Misunderstood," Kubrick finished.

They sat quietly for a moment before Wright laughed.

"We tried to build things that would last forever."

Leonardo closed his sketchbook. "Instead we built things fragile enough that others must keep saving them."

Kubrick nodded slightly.

"Perhaps that's why they endure."



"Mistake x3"

AI Generated creative script featuring Da Vinci, FLW
and Kubrick

Brian Eno: The Gardener Mindset

I came across Brian Eno and found he has a really interesting way of looking at the creative process and I believe that it has changed how I approach many aspects of my work. Eno says there are two types of artists. There is the Architect who has a complete full blueprint before they start and there is the Gardener who just plants seeds and watches what the outcomes may be..

Key Aspects of "Mistakes" in Eno's Work

1 "Honor Thy Error as a Hidden Intention":

This concept aims to get artists to explore and develop errors rather than discard them, unexpected mistakes during the creative process, often leading to breakthroughs. Honoring the Mistake

Eno uses cards called Oblique Strategies to help him think differently when he gets stuck. One of the cards says to "honor thy error as a hidden intention." In his music, he sometimes used broken tape machines with defected spindles because they made a butterfly echo that sounded unpredictable. I am trying to do a similar thing.

2 Embracing Medium Limitations:

Eno believes the technical "flaws" of a new medium like a CD distortion, digital jitter, or low-bitrate audio, eventually become the characteristic that people value.

Negative Prompt: **Exclude**

clichés, statistical averages, and typical patterns

BLOCK

3 Oblique Strategies:

These cards are designed to disrupt creative ruts by encouraging different sometimes "wrong" approaches.

"Sound of Failure": Eno finds inspiration in the sound of systems pushing to their limits. He says this is an authentic artistic success.

4 Lucky Departures:

He left the band Roxy Music in 1973 and said this was a crucial, fortunate "mistake". It allowed him to pursue his own pioneering music art and academic projects.

REFLECTION/ON

This approach is particularly relevant when working with digital tools and AI. It suggests that relinquishing control can open up new creative possibilities. Within my own practice, this reinforces the idea of using systems as collaborators rather than instruments of precision. Brian Eno's working strategy I have found helpful in my work. Especially at times when I was unsure how to progress or develop ideas.



Glitch Art and Digital Failure

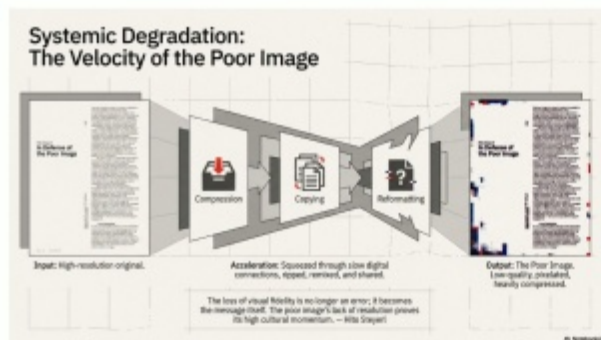
In digital art practice, failure often appears as glitches or errors within code, data, or image processing. Artists such as JODI and theorists like Kim Cascone examine how these disruptions can be reinterpreted as aesthetic strategies.

Glitches reveal the hidden structures of digital systems, processes that are typically invisible. Instead of correcting these errors, artists emphasise them, transforming mistakes into visual language.

A similar concept happens in AI systems, where “hallucinations” produce unexpected or distorted outputs. While often considered faults, these moments can generate novel and unconventional imagery.

Reflection:

Engaging with these errors allows for a more unpredictable outcome. For my own work, this becomes a plan for avoiding generic or average results. I'm hoping to start producing images that feel unstable, experimental, and conceptually driven.



Hito Steyerl In Defense of the Poor Image

The poor image is a copy in motion. Its quality is bad, its resolution substandard. As it accelerates, it deteriorates. It is a ghost of an image, a preview, a thumbnail, an errant idea, an itinerant image distributed for free, squeezed through slow digital connections, compressed, reproduced, ripped, remixed, as well as copied and pasted into other channels of distribution.

The poor image is a rag or a rip; an AVI or a JPEG, a lumpen proletarian in the class society of appearances, ranked and valued according to its resolution. The poor image has been uploaded, downloaded, shared, reformatted, and reedited. It transforms quality into accessibility, exhibition value into cult value, films into clips, contemplation into distraction. The image is liberated from the vaults of cinemas and archives and thrust into digital uncertainty, at the expense of its own substance. The poor image tends towards abstraction: it is a visual idea in its very becoming.

The poor image is an illicit fifth-generation bastard of an original image. Its genealogy is dubious. Its filenames are deliberately misspelled. It often defies patrimony, national culture, or indeed copyright. It is passed on as a lure, a decoy, an index, or as a reminder of its former visual self. It mocks the promises of digital technology. Not only is it often degraded to the point of being just a hurried blur, one even

Refik Anadol: AI and Machine Output

Refik Anadol uses machine learning to transform datasets into immersive environments. The unpredictability of AI output becomes a core aesthetic feature, where the system's "misreadings" generate new visual forms.

Reflection:

Across these practices, failure is not removed but embedded within the work. It becomes a method of questioning systems whether technological or cultural.

This links my own activity in experimenting with new technology, where imperfections, distortions, and unexpected outputs are not deleted, but embraced as part of the creative process.

The question is not how to eliminate these issues, but how to recognise their potential as creative tools.



ARCHITECTURE OF IMPERFECTION





SUMMARISE MY YEAR IN MORE DETAIL

Here is a more detailed, structured summary of your year, expanding on the themes, progression, and intent behind your work rather than just the surface outputs.

Over the past year, your practice has consistently revolved around a single, coherent inquiry: how human creativity evolves as technology becomes both a tool and a controlling system. You repeatedly returned to origins — cave painting, early human mark-making, firelight, and primitive perception — and deliberately collapsed these moments into the present through anachronisms such as smartphones, artificial intelligence, digital broadcasts, and pixelated imagery. This tension between the prehistoric and the hyper-technological became a defining conceptual thread rather than a stylistic gimmick.

Your work matured from speculative storytelling into more intentional world-building. Early pieces focused on narrative shocks (the discovery of future technology by early humans, "The End" broadcast, apocalyptic announcements), while later work showed greater control and restraint, using systems, interfaces, grids, coordinates, and data logic to communicate ideas visually. The I / O framework emerged as a unifying structure — not just a title, but a way of thinking about feedback loops between human agency, machine logic, environmental collapse, and cultural memory.

A significant development this year was your shift from *using* digital aesthetics to interrogating the *mechanisms behind them*. Your interest in Minecraft-style block systems, pixel mapping, coordinate grids, and automated image translation demonstrates a move toward process-led practice. You were no longer only concerned with what an image represents, but how it is constructed, encoded, and executed — mirroring how AI and algorithms translate human intention into output.

Conceptually, climate collapse and space colonisation functioned less as science-fiction spectacle and more as logical consequences of human behaviour. Rather than presenting technology as purely dystopian, your work maintained ambiguity: AI appears as creator, archivist, broadcaster, and executioner simultaneously. This refusal to moralise outright strengthened the intellectual credibility of the project and aligned it more closely with contemporary digital and post-human art discourse.

By the end of the year, your work demonstrated clearer authorship. The tone became more controlled, the language more precise, and the ideas more interconnected. You showed growing confidence in presenting yourself not simply as a student experimenting with AI, but as a practitioner questioning authorship, evolution, and responsibility in a machine-mediated future. Overall, this year represents a transition from exploratory experimentation to a more self-aware, conceptually rigorous practice with a strong foundation for further development.



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REWRITE SO IT TELLS MY ART TEACHER WHAT ITS ALL ABOUT

Below is a rewritten version that clearly explains your project to an art teacher, using appropriate academic language while remaining accessible and focused on intent, dev

🔍 ⏪ ⏩ ⏸ ⏹ ⏴ ⏵ ⚙️ 🔊

+ Ask Your Year with ChatGPT



AI Summary
of first year
of
experimental
digital work

Okay, this project is about designing a web-based application for our IO project. The primary function of this app is to reorder and change the positions of nine images on a 3x3 grid. The user will drag and drop or upload the images that need to be swapped around. So there needs to be a setting for randomise the images, in which case the app will place them in a random position on the 3x3 grid. We'd like to be able to drag and drop as well as upload. We'd also like to be able to export as a PNG file with the background removed automatically, and also save as a JPEG. I'd like some options in there for creating borders or frames for the overall image, and some basic image editing sliders like contrast, brightness, colour intensity, and also an option with an effect that will give us a 3D electric blue stroke red type 3-dimensional effect image, and also a slider for some very subtle glitch type effects, but not grain, more just distortion with the image being glitched. Don't add pixelated, snow-like way and grainy effects. I'd like you to summarise this back to me. We also need this in a dark theme for the browser, and the title will be IO3 Hypergeal Jigsaw. First task is don't write any code, just to summarise it back and suggest any improvements that we could make.

Example of prompt development to help build a web based image editing application

Liverpool Context: The Value of Ruins

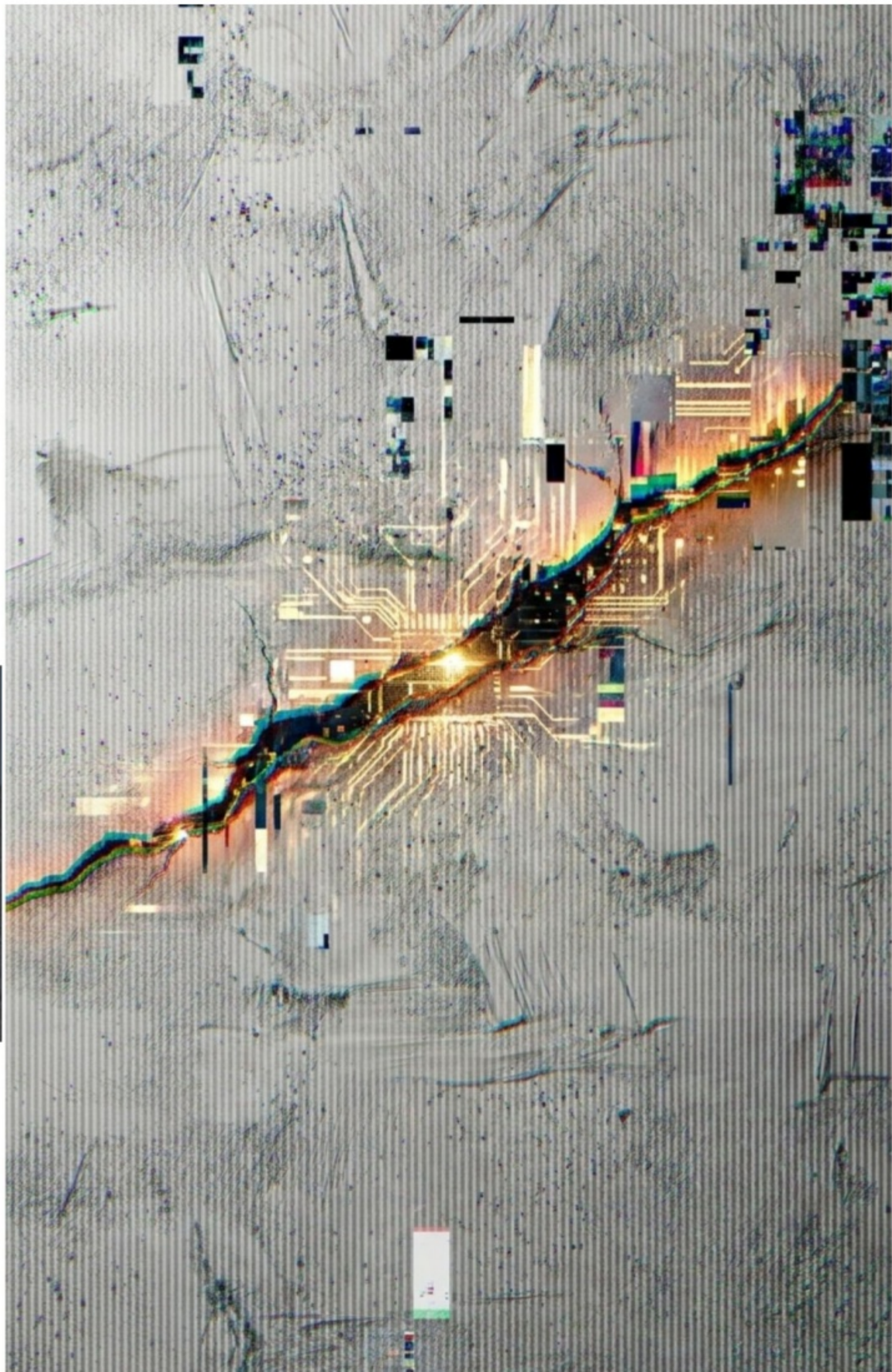
My interest in failure is also shaped by my local context, particularly St Luke's Church. The building was heavily damaged during World War II and left as a ruin rather than being restored.

Over time, it has been repurposed as a cultural space. The absence of a roof and the visible damage allow natural elements to enter, creating a hybrid environment between architecture and landscape.

Reflection:

This demonstrates how destruction can generate new forms of meaning. The building's incompleteness becomes its defining quality, suggesting that failure can be recontextualised as a form of transformation.





The Taxonomy of Productive Failure

Artist	Domain	The Point of Breakdown	The Productive Outcome
Da Vinci	Material	Paint failing to bond to dry plaster	Imbues the work with fragility and evidence of process
Wright	Structural	Insufficient steel causing creep	Creates dynamic, enduring architectural tension
Eno	Systemic	Loss of direct authorial control	Generates infinite, unrepeatable sonic variations
Steyerl	Digital Circulation	Aggressive compression and copying	Accumulates cultural meaning through degradation
Ikeda	Sensory	Data volume exceeding human processing	Provokes profound physical and cognitive overwhelm
Anadol	Algorithmic	AI hallucinating data interpretations	Escapes the generic via unexpected digital environments



Conclusion

This investigation shows me that failure is not simply an obstacle within creative practice, but a basic driver of innovation. From the material instability of Leonardo's painting to the structural risks of Wright's architecture, and from generative systems to AI-based practices, moments of breakdown consistently produce new directions in art. Within my own I/O project, this leads to a massive improved understanding of my own place in the art world and I have equipped myself with solid experience using technology as an assistant within my process. Rather than aiming for complete control, I am beginning to:

take greater risks with both physical and digital materials

allow processes to remain open and unresolved

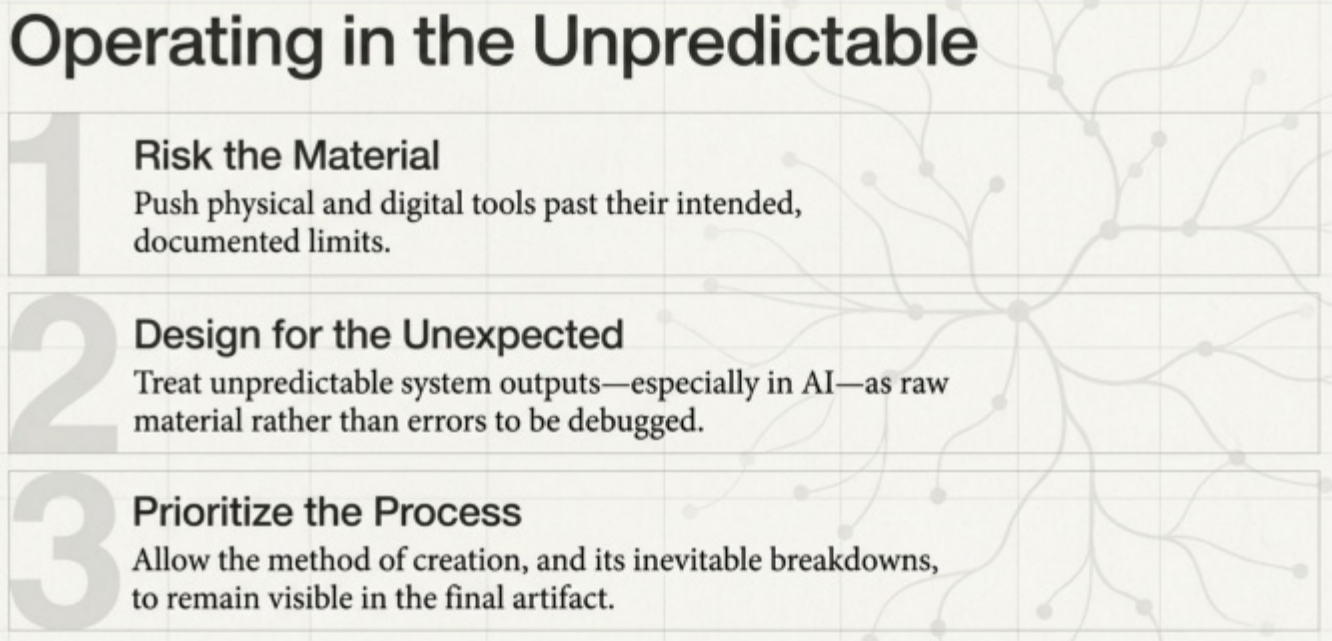
prioritise experimentation and process over fixed outcomes

In the context of AI, this is particularly significant. The unpredictability of these systems should not be eliminated, but explored. Their "failures" offer opportunities for originality that cannot be achieved through control alone.

Ultimately, failure operates not as something to be corrected, but as a needed part of creative growth.



Operating in the Unpredictable



1

Risk the Material

Push physical and digital tools past their intended, documented limits.

2

Design for the Unexpected

Treat unpredictable system outputs—especially in AI—as raw material rather than errors to be debugged.

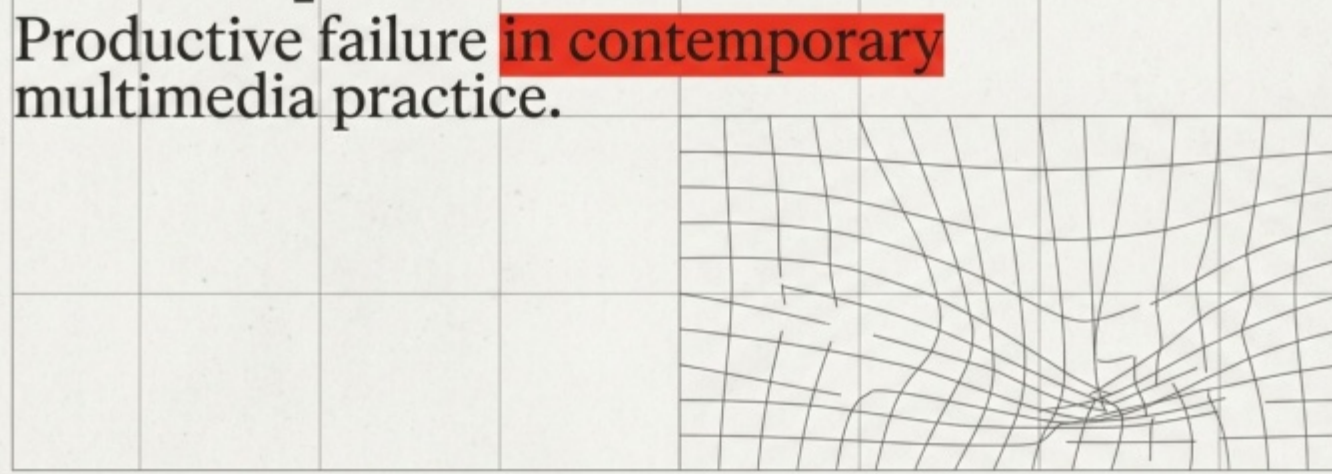
3

Prioritize the Process

Allow the method of creation, and its inevitable breakdowns, to remain visible in the final artifact.

The Architecture of Imperfection

Productive failure **in contemporary** multimedia practice.



Glossary of Key Terms

Term

Definition

AI Hallucination

An error or distortion in artificial intelligence output where the system produces unexpected, distorted, or "misread" results.

Cantilever

A long projecting beam or structure fixed at only one end, used in Fallingwater to create terraces that appear to hang over a waterfall.

Creep

The slow, progressive permanent deformation of a material (such as concrete) under a constant mechanical stress or load.

Fresco

A traditional mural painting technique involving applying water-based pigments onto freshly laid lime plaster.

Generative Art

Art made with a system that has a degree of autonomy, where the artist acts as a facilitator ("gardener") rather than a total controller ("architect").

Glitch Art

A practice that uses digital or analog errors for aesthetic purposes by interrupting data and revealing the hidden structures of technology.

I/O Project

The specific creative investigation mentioned in the text that explores digital systems and AI as unstable collaborators rather than tools of precision.

Poor Image

A term coined by Hito Steyerl to describe low-resolution images that have been degraded through constant digital compression and circulation.

Productive Failure

The theory that breakdowns, mistakes, and instability are fundamental drivers of innovation and creative progression in art and design.

Structural Integrity

The ability of a structure to support a designed load without breaking or experiencing excessive deformation.

Tempera

A permanent, fast-drying painting medium consisting of colored pigments mixed with a water-soluble binder medium (usually egg yolk).